

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKSHEET

Subject: Social Studies

Topic: The Western Desert (Thar)

Grade: IV (Four)

Answer Key: Teacher's Copy

Section: Solved Exemplar

Status: Fully Completed

Exemplar Guidelines: This document contains verified, highly accurate solutions for the Presidency School Social Studies Grade IV Worksheet on 'The Western Desert'. All answers are fully grounded in the textbook chapter to serve as a reliable reference for grading, exam preparation, and curriculum design.

I. FILL IN THE BLANKS

1. The Thar Desert is mainly located in Rajasthan.
2. Large heaps of sand are called sand dunes.
3. A place with water in a desert is called an oasis.
4. The Thar Desert receives very scanty rainfall.
5. The ship of the desert is the camel.

II. CHOOSE THE CORRECT ANSWER

1. The Thar Desert is mainly found in:

☒ Rajasthan (Correct)

☐ Kerala

☐ Assam

2. Which is a desert plant?

☒ Cactus (Correct)

☐ Lotus

☐ Banana

3. Desert climate is generally:

☒ Hot and dry (Correct)

☐ Cold and wet

☐ Cool and rainy

III. TRUE OR FALSE

1. Desert plants have special adaptations.

TRUE

Justification: Thorny leaves reduce water loss, and long roots tap deep groundwater.

2. Camels can walk easily on sand.

TRUE

Justification: They have long legs and padded feet designed for loose sandy terrain.

3. Desert regions receive heavy rainfall.

FALSE

Justification: The Thar receives extremely scanty, sparse, or irregular rainfall.

4. Some people rear sheep, goats and camels.

TRUE

Justification: Livestock trading and rearing are primary occupations for desert dwellers.

5. People in deserts need to conserve water.

TRUE

Justification: Extreme scarcity makes water harvesting and storage (like in tanks) critical.

IV. ANSWER BRIEFLY (PART 1)

1. How do camels survive in the desert?

Answer: Camels are highly adapted to survive in harsh desert conditions in three main ways:

- **Padded Feet:** Their long, muscular legs and wide, padded feet prevent them from sinking into the hot, loose desert sand, letting them walk easily.
- **Mound of Fat (Hump):** The hump on their back stores reserves of fat, which allows them to travel long distances across the sand without food and water for several days.
- **Thick Skin:** Their thick hide shields them from intense heat during the day and keeps them warm during cool desert nights.

2. Name two occupations of desert people.

Answer: The two major occupations of the inhabitants of the Thar Desert are:

- **Animal Rearing / Livestock Trading:** People breed and rear sheep, goats, camels, and cattle to obtain milk, meat, wool, and skins for trade.
- **Agriculture:** Wherever irrigation water is available (such as regions served by canals), farmers cultivate robust crops like bajra, jowar, wheat, and mustard.

3. Why do some desert people lead a nomadic life?

Answer: Due to the extreme heat and severe shortage of water, pasture land is very scarce and scattered. This search for drinking water and green pastures for their animals forces many desert people—such as the *Banjaras* (or gypsies)—to lead a nomadic life, constantly migrating from one place to another with their households and animal herds.

V. FILL IN THE BLANKS (PART 2)

1. Canals (such as the Indira Gandhi Canal) help bring water to dry areas.
2. People store water in tanks (built in their houses).
3. Water conservation is important in the Thar / Western Desert.
4. Ghoomar / Kalbeliya is a famous Rajasthani folk dance.

VI. ANSWER BRIEFLY (PART 2)

1. Why is livestock important to desert people?

Answer: Rearing livestock is a crucial means of livelihood because agricultural cultivation is highly restricted by dry sandy land and drought. Animals like goats, sheep, and cattle provide stable food supplies like milk and meat, as well as tradeable wool. Camels, additionally, serve as the indispensable primary means of transport across the vast desert.

2. Why are canals and tanks useful in desert areas?

Answer: Canals and tanks are essential tools for combating severe desert aridity:

- Canals: The *Indira Gandhi Canal* (or Rajasthan Canal) diverts vital water from major northern rivers, enabling extensive agricultural farming and transforming desolate sand plains into green, cultivable crop fields.
- Tanks: Traditional household rainwater harvesting tanks capture the scarce, brief rainfall, storing it securely so that families have drinking water during the long, dry periods of the year.

3. Name one food, dress or festival associated with Rajasthan.

Answer: Here are key cultural symbols of Rajasthan (any one of these represents the state's colorful tradition):

- Food: *Daal-baati-churma* is the famous traditional dish loved throughout the region.
- Dress: Women wear elegant *ghaghra-choli* and *odhni*, while men wear *dhotis*, *kurta*, and colorful *pagri* (turbans).
- Festival: Traditional festivals such as *Gangaur*, *Teej*, and the popular *Pushkar Camel Fair* are celebrated with immense color and joy.